

month! Launched on 10th September 1990, this system quickly expanded from being a local tool, to being available on a network, to being a popular service available all over the Web. The servers on which Archie was hosted could be accessed by the local client xarchie, to sending queries via e-mail, and later via Web interfaces, like we do today.

The name Archie was derived from the word archive. Clones of Archie—Jughead and Veronica—were, however, inspired by the comic book series.

Then, talking about search engines, we should talk about Gopher, which was created in 1991 by Mark McCahill, Farhad Anklesaria, Paul Lindner, Dan Torrey, and Bob Alberti of the University of Minnesota. Gopher was designed to act as an anonymous FTP service while trying to incorporate new Web features. It contained a file-like hierarchical system that was familiar to users, an easy-to-use syntax, was free to use, and could be created easily.

The name Gopher was chosen because its users would program it to “go for” information.

The Gopher protocol ceased gaining popularity as soon as it was made famous. The primary reasons for this were the University of Minnesota’s announcement on charging licensing fees for the use of its Gopher server, Web browsers like Mosaic quickly duplicated Gopher’s functionality and finally, because its defined file format and structure was too rigid to use.

December: The Internet Is Born

The Internet was originally envisioned by Tim Berners-Lee, an independent contractor at CERN in 1980, when he created a database software to catalogue people and software models while working at CERN. In this database, each new page of information had to be linked to an already existing page, a term later known as hypertext. He called his software ENQUIRE.